



Here are the remedies for Knoppix headaches, faltering game frames, nasty bootups, nastier errors and cellular annoyances...

#### Linux not booting from disk

While re-installing Windows 98 SE on my PC that also runs Red Hat Linux 9.0, I received a warning about modifying the boot sector. Upon restarting, I found the LiLo boot menu missing. I tried the solution given in one of your earlier issues to a similar problem, but Linux would not boot from my boot disk. SOS!

**Nikhil**

Use the loadlin program to boot into Linux from DOS mode. loadlin is located in the dosutils directory on the Red Hat 9 Installation CD. Copy loadlin and vmlinuz—the Red Hat 9 image file—located under the autoboot directory onto your Windows partition. Restart in DOS mode, and type `loadlin C:\vmlinuz root=/dev/hdXX` at the command prompt. Replace **XX** in **hdXX** with the location of the Linux root (/) partition, e.g. hda1. This will boot you into Linux. Modify the `/etc/lilo.conf` file to reflect Windows by adding the following entries to the end of the file:

```
other=/dev/hda1
optional
label=Windows
```

Here, change **'hda1'** to your Windows drive. Now, type **'lilo'** at the command prompt to place the Linux loader in the MBR.

#### Red Hat not playing MP3s

I am unable to play MP3 files ever since I installed Red Hat Linux 9. I downloaded

and installed the latest xmms (1.2.8) from [www.xmms.org](http://www.xmms.org), but MP3s just won't play. The progress bar moves quickly and the speakers emit nothing! My sound card is configured properly, since I can play audio CDs.

I don't know how to play VCDs either. I am unable to find software that plays .dat files.

My PC is a Pentium IV 1.5 GHz that has 128 MB RAM, an 845 motherboard and an AC97 onboard sound card.

**Ashish Mehta**

Unfortunately Ashish, Red Hat 9 does not support MP3s anymore since the codec is no longer free. However, there are a few workarounds. One is to use the encoder library from an older Linux installation. Copy `libmpg123.so` located in `/usr/lib/xmms/Input/` from a PC running Red Hat 7.3 or older, to the same location on your PC. Else, download the source rpm for an older version of xmms, preferably `xmms-1.2.7-2.i386`, from <http://www.megaloman.com/~hany/RPM/libmpg123.so.html>. Next, run the `rpm -ivh xmms-1.2.7-2.src.rpm` command. Replace `xmms-1.2.7-2.src.rpm` with the name of the downloaded file. This installs the source code in `usr/src/redhat/SOURCES/`. **'cd'**(change to a directory) to this directory and unzip the xmms file with extension .tar.bz2, using the `bunzip2` filename.

This replaces the .tar.bz2 file with a

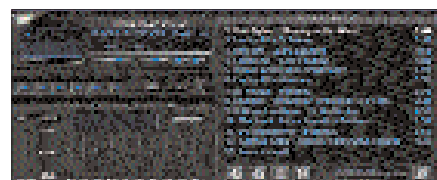
new .tar file. Uncompress it using `tar xvf filename.tar`.

This creates a new directory containing the xmms source code. **'cd'** to this directory that has the name of the tar file and type **'./configure'**. Next, **'cd'** to the sub-directory named **'Input'**, and type the following commands one after the other:

```
make
make install
```

This compiles the MP3 libraries and installs them in `/usr/lib/xmms/Input`. You should be able to play MP3s after this.

Check if the library is installed properly. Open XMMS, right-click on the main



Open XMMS and right-click on the main window to access Visualization.

window, and go to **Visualization > Visualization plug-ins**, or use the shortcut **[Ctrl] + [V]**. Click on the Audio I/O Plugins tab and check if MPEG Layer 1/2/3 Player 1.2.7 [`libmpg123.so`] is listed and enabled in Input Plugins.

As for playing .dat files, use mplayer, which you can download from [www.mplayerhq.hu](http://www.mplayerhq.hu).